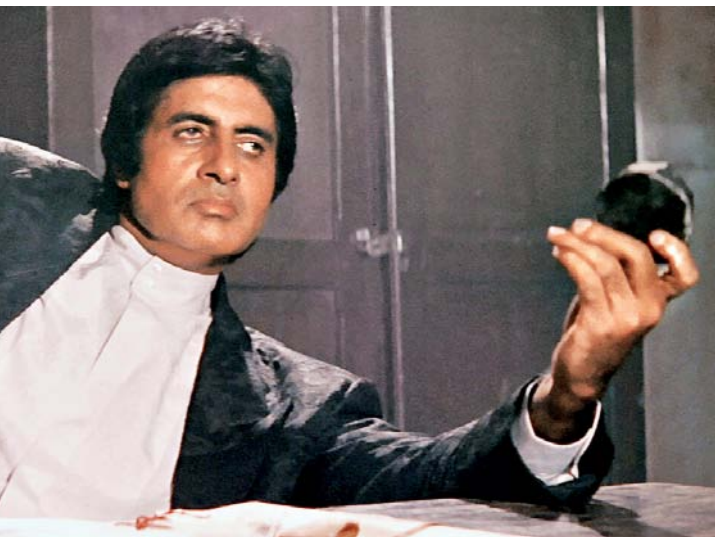




By RANVEER SINGH

# "He defines the very word stardom"

**He's one of the most versatile actors in history.** An iconic figure. He defines the word 'stardom'. He's one of a kind. Simply put, THE. GREATEST. OF. ALL. TIME.

Amitabh Bachchan is to Hindi movies what Michael Jordan is to basketball. Sure, it's a loose comparison, but both are considered to be the unanimous GOATS in their respective disciplines. Amitabh Bachchan is intrinsic to Indian culture, such is his place in our lives. His body of work deserves a giant museum.

What does he mean to me personally? Let's just say that the chambers of my heart are walled with posters of him. I say unequivocally that he's my greatest idol, a deity I have revered.

It was my grandmother who ushered me into the fantastic world of Amitabh Bachchan and his artistry. She'd feed me her special home-cooked Sindhi delicacy sael bread whilst playing VHS after VHS of Amitabh Bachchan movies. And she would emphatically tell me, "One day you have to grow up and be like him!" He was the exemplar in inspiring me to become an actor. I was mesmerised by him in *Shahenshah* and ***Agneepath*** *(above)*. I even loved *Ajooba*, *Jaadugar* and *Toofan*. I have been in awe of him all my life. I have literally grown up dreaming of becoming like him.

Can you imagine what an unforgettable moment it was for me when I received my first ever Best Actor award for *Bajirao Mastani* and he was present in the audience, applauding me! At my wedding, my then newly-wedded wife, Deepika, and I danced with him on '*Jumma Chumma*'. That meant the world to me too. The memories connected to him constitute the highlight reel of my life. He has seen some of my work and sent across handwritten letters expressing deep appreciation. I have kept them in a safe among my most treasured belongings.

**"What does he mean to me personally? Let's just say the chambers of my heart are walled with posters of him. He's my greatest idol, a deity I revere"**

His generous deeds are a testament to how magnanimous an artist he is. His bearing as a preeminent member of society is impeccable. I could elaborate on the depth and range of his craft and the power of his emotive faculties, but it would run into volumes.

His legacy and contribution to the arts are beyond comparison. He's a Titan, a Colossus. He is THE Amitabh Bachchan. ■

***Ranveer Singh is a leading Bollywood actor***




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